

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 257

By Powers

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the Farmers Helping Farmers initiative and its leader, Dan Pearman, for their remarkable efforts in assisting fellow farmers in East Tennessee.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should specially recognize those estimable citizens and initiatives that have contributed significantly to the betterment of their communities; and

WHEREAS, one such initiative is the Farmers Helping Farmers relief effort, which began with a heartfelt post from Dan Pearman, who wanted farmers in Cocke and Greene counties to know they were not alone in the aftermath of the terrible devastation brought by Hurricane Helene in September 2024; and

WHEREAS, Dan Pearman, along with farmers in Claiborne County, organized efforts to gather hay and supplies for farmers in Greene and Cocke counties, lining up approximately 500 rolls of hay and a significant amount of feed and other essentials; and

WHEREAS, some fifteen trucks loaded with supplies soon pulled out from Mays' Loadout Barn on Highway 63 bound for Cocke County, with the commitment that this would not be the last convoy, and that future efforts would focus on Greene County as well; and

WHEREAS, Dan Pearman's leadership and the spirit of "farmers helping farmers" have inspired countless individuals to come together, providing hope and support to those affected by adverse conditions; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Pearman was recently recognized at the Tennessee Cattlemen's Association convention in Murfreesboro, receiving the John Bartee Distinguished Service Award for his leadership in organizing multiple hay convoys to Cocke, Greene, and Unicoi counties to assist livestock producers with feeding their animals in the aftermath of Hurricane Helene; and

WHEREAS, in total, over 130 loads of donated hay, feed, and other supplies were provided to the affected farmers, demonstrating the power of community and collective effort; and

WHEREAS, having recently experienced a couple of life-threatening medical conditions, Dan Pearman felt a divine calling to help, and his efforts, along with the generous contributions of many others, resulted in substantial relief for those in need; and

WHEREAS, the Farmers Helping Farmers initiative to assist recovery efforts in East Tennessee after Hurricane Helene involved some 125 people in Cocke County, 190 people in Greene County, and 140 people in Unicoi County, who collectively donated hay, time, and other resources; and

WHEREAS, the actions of Dan Pearman and the Farmers Helping Farmers initiative stand as a testament to the power of dedication, compassion, and leadership, and they are wholly deserving of the respect and admiration of this General Assembly; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the Farmers Helping Farmers initiative and Dan Pearman for their outstanding efforts in assisting fellow farmers in East Tennessee and extend to them our best wishes for continued success in all their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.